

How TELECOM Is TRANSFORMING RURAL INDIA



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This report shares an overview of the potential of the telecom industry in rural India and the various technologies that can help drive the initiatives

India has no dearth of technological and business innovations for rural areas. However, telecom policies and scams have created a negative impact on the growth of this sector in rural India. Certain policies have forced Internet service providers to rethink their investments there.

The Indian telecommunications sector has grown rapidly in the last few years. India now has the second largest network in the world, next only to China. In rural areas, tele-density was 56.87 per cent, at the end of August 2017, whereas in urban areas, it was 173.72 per cent.

To enable India's transition into a digital economy and knowledge society, large investments in infrastructure, both in optical-fibre cables and towers, for wireless transmission are required. The government is committed to extending the reach of mobile networks to around 50,000 remote, rural villages, with support from Universal Services Obligation Fund (USOF). In addition, investments are being made to lay optical-fibre cables for high-speed broadband connectivity in rural areas.

Given below are some initiatives that are being taken by the government of India in this direction.

- BharatNet
- Network for left-wing extremism areas
- Connecting the unconnected
- Wi-Fi hotspots
- Digital villages

The future of telecommunications is 5G. However, a large number of people in India live in rural and low-income zones. They live without any wireless signal coverage and connectivity. Presently, cellular technology is mostly an urban concept.

According to 2015 statistics, about 56 per cent of the world's

population does not have access to the Internet. In September 2015, the United Nations (UN) signed Universal and Affordable Internet Provisioning for Everyone, Everywhere by 2020.

Villages can be classified as small, mid-sized or large based on area and population, and can be located in hilly or plain areas. And wireless network topology depends on factors like size of village, distribution of residential houses and terrain map of village.

Broadband technology allows high-speed transmission of voice, video and data

